

Raising a Superhero

A Parent's Activity Workbook for Turning ADHD Traits into Strengths and Growing Your Patience

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A Note Before You Begin

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This book is for general education and family activities only. It is not medical, psychological or educational advice, and it does not diagnose, treat or cure any condition. Every child is different, and so is every family.

For decisions about diagnosis, treatment, medication or school support, please talk with your child's qualified professionals. If you are worried about your child's safety or your own, contact local emergency or crisis services right away.

The activities use ordinary household items and an adult nearby. Adapt each one to your child's age, abilities and safety, and stop any activity that is causing distress.

The superhero language in this book is a friendly way of talking about strengths. It has no connection to any comic, film or character brand.

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Welcome, Hero Guardian

If you are holding this book, you are probably tired.

Not the kind of tired a good night's sleep fixes. The kind that comes from saying the same sentence four times, from the morning scramble for shoes, from the phone call from school, from the quiet worry at 10 p.m. about whether you are doing this right.

First, a few things that are true. You are not failing. Your child is not broken. And the fact that you opened a book about this tells me you are exactly the kind of parent your child needs.

This workbook is built on one simple idea. The traits that make daily life hard for many kids with ADHD often have a stronger side. Intense focus can become deep skill. Endless energy can become drive. Fast, jumpy ideas can become creativity. Big feelings can become a big heart. None of this happens by magic, and none of it replaces the support your child may need. It happens in small, ordinary moments, when an adult notices a trait, gives it somewhere useful to go and stays calm enough to see it through.

That last part is the hard part. So this book has two jobs. It gives you simple activities to do with your child, and it gives you small, practical ways to build your own patience while you do them.

There is no grand plan to follow and no homework for your child. Most activities take ten to twenty minutes. You can start anywhere. You can skip a page. You can write in the margins, spill tea on it and come back after a rough week.

You are the Hero Guardian here. Your child is the hero in training. Let's begin.

How To Use This Book

This book works best in small bites. Here is the rhythm that suits most families.

One module at a time. There are eight modules. Each one focuses on a single trait and the strength it can grow into. Plan about one to two weeks per module, though you can go faster or slower.

One mission at a time. Each module has five missions. A mission is a short activity you do with your child, usually ten to twenty minutes, with little or no preparation. Read the left page before you start. Fill in the right page afterward, even if it is just a few words.

One Guardian Pause per mission. Every mission ends with a tiny patience practice for you. It takes under a minute. These add up faster than you would expect.

One Debrief per module. At the end of each module, you look back at what worked and choose what to keep. This is where the real learning lives, so please don't skip it.

Make it fit. The ages in mind are roughly five to twelve, but every child is different. If a mission feels too young or too old, change it. If your child says no, try again another day or in another form. Forcing it defeats the point.

Keep it light. If an activity turns into a battle, stop. The goal is connection first. A mission that ends in laughter after two minutes has done its job.

Use the back of the book. The Patience Toolkit, Phrase Bank, 30-Day Mission Tracker and Wins Log are there to be used between missions. Flip to them whenever you need them.

Quick Start: Where To Begin

You do not have to start at page one. Choose the doorway that matches your hardest moment right now, and begin there.

If This Is Your Hardest Part	Start With	First Mission
Mornings and getting out the door	Module 6: Sidekick Systems	6.1 The Morning Mission Board
Meltdowns and big feelings	Module 4: Big Heart	4.1 Feelings Weather Report
Homework battles	Module 7: Learning Style	7.2 The Homework Launch
Stopping a favourite activity	Module 1: Deep Focus	1.3 The Gentle Landing
Too much energy at the wrong moment	Module 2: Active Power	2.2 Move, Then Think
Friendships and confidence	Module 8: Allies and Comebacks	8.4 The Brag Board

If you only have ten minutes this week, try one of these five starter missions: 1.1 The Interest Inventory, 1.3 The Gentle Landing, 4.1 Feelings Weather Report, 6.1 The Morning Mission Board or 8.4 The Brag Board. Each one is small, and each one gives you something to build on.

A gentle four-week pace:

- **Week 1:** Fill in My Hero's Profile and My Guardian Baseline. Try one starter mission.
- **Week 2:** Do two missions from the module you chose. Use a Guardian Pause each time.
- **Week 3:** Do two more, then complete that module's Debrief.
- **Week 4:** Pick the next module, or repeat the missions that worked best.

Slow is fine. A mission done twice, calmly, is worth more than five rushed ones.

The Hero Framework

Every module in this book follows the same simple shape. Learn it once and the rest of the book gets easier.

Step	What It Means	Example
Spot the Power	Notice the trait and name its strong side	Your child loses track of time while building. That is deep focus.
Name the Pressure Point	Be honest about where it causes trouble	Stopping the build for dinner ends in tears.
Choose a Sidekick Tool	Pick one small strategy to try	A ten-minute and five-minute warning before the switch.
Run the Mission	Do a short activity together	Child teaches you what they are building.
Take a Guardian Pause	Practice patience in the moment	Slow breath out before you say the warning.
Debrief	Look back and keep what worked	Warnings helped. Dinner still needs a snack first.

Why this shape? Because it keeps you out of two traps. One trap is only seeing the problems. The other is pretending there are none. The Hero Framework asks you to hold both at once: this trait is a gift in one setting and a struggle in another, and your job is to help your child tell the difference.

You do not need to get it right the first time. You just need to try something small, watch what happens and adjust.

Try it now. Write one trait you see in your child right now, its strong side and where it trips you both up.

My Hero's Profile

My hero's name:

Age:

Things my hero loves most right now:

Things my hero could talk about for an hour:

What makes my hero laugh:

Times of day my hero is at their best:

Times of day that are hardest:

Things that help my hero calm down:

Things that make everything harder:

One thing that makes me proud of my hero:

One strength I have noticed that others might miss:

Origin story. Write a few lines about your hero's early years, the moment you first noticed their special way of seeing the world, and one memory that still makes you smile.

My Guardian Baseline

The hardest time of day for me:

Three signs that I am running low on patience:

The thing I say or do when I lose my cool:

What I wish I did instead:

What recharges me, even for five minutes:

Someone I can call when it is a rough day:

My patience level today (circle one): 1 2 3 4 5

My promise to myself. Write one kind sentence you can say to yourself on a hard day, the way you would say it to a friend.

MODULE 1

Deep Focus

From Hyperfocus To Deep Focus

★ Meet The Power

Watch your child when they are building, drawing, gaming or hunting for bugs, and you may see something remarkable. The room fades. The noise fades. They go all in.

Many kids with ADHD can focus intensely on things that fascinate them. It can look like a contradiction. How can a child who cannot sit through a worksheet spend three hours on a Lego city? The usual answer is interest. When something is new, exciting or deeply meaningful, attention locks on. When it is not, attention slips.

That is not laziness, and it is not a choice. It is simply how attention often works for these kids. The good news is that it points to something valuable. Deep focus is the engine behind mastery. People who become really good at anything, from chess to coding to cooking, have it.

The challenge is steering. Deep focus does not always arrive on schedule, and it is hard to switch off. Many parents know the sound of “just five more minutes” and the storm that follows when time is up.

This module has two goals. First, help you discover what lights your child up. Second, help your child use that spark to build real skill while learning smoother ways to start and stop.

For you, the Hero Guardian, the work is patience at the edges. Transitions are where most meltdowns live. A little planning, a calm voice and a gentle landing make them far easier.

★ **The goal is not to cut the spark. It is to give it a runway.** ★

★ Trait Map

What You See	What It Can Grow Into	Where It Trips You Up	Sidekick Tool
Lost in a favourite activity	Deep skill and real expertise	Ignores calls, meals and bedtime	Time warnings and a gentle landing
Talks about one topic constantly	Knowledge and confidence	Others tire of the topic	Teach Me Time with a trusted audience
Hard to start dull tasks	Strong drive for what matters	Homework and chores stall	Link boring tasks to a favourite interest
Resists stopping	Persistence	Meltdowns at transitions	Predictable endings and a "next time" plan

⓫ Patience Check-In

Think about the last time your child struggled to stop something they loved. What happened in your body when you realised you were about to ask them to switch?

What would a calmer version of that moment look like?

MISSION 1.1

The Interest Inventory

15 Minutes | You Will Need: Paper, pens, a comfy spot

The Idea

You cannot steer a spark you have not found. This mission is a relaxed conversation to map what your child loves, without any pressure to be "useful" or "age appropriate."

Ask with real curiosity, not as a quiz. Kids can tell the difference. Interests that seem silly, like a particular video game or a type of slime, are worth writing down. Behind every interest sit skills your child is already building.

When you are done, you will have a list you can come back to throughout this book.

Steps

1. Sit somewhere relaxed, side by side rather than face to face.
2. Say you are making a list of everything they love. Let them go first.
3. Write down every answer without judgment, even if it surprises you.
4. Ask one follow-up for each: "What do you like most about that?"
5. Circle the top three together.

Say This

> *"I'm making a list of the things you love most. What's on it?"*
> *"Tell me more about that. What's the best part?"*

Plan It

When Will We Try This?

What I Need To Get Ready:

MISSION 1.1 NOTES

The Interest Inventory

Notice

- ☐ Which topics make your child's voice speed up or eyes light up.
- ☐ Interests that repeat across the list.
- ☐ Anything you did not know they cared about.
- ☐ Whether they loosened up as the list grew.

Guardian Pause

Before you start, take one slow breath out, longer than the breath in. Tell yourself: "For fifteen minutes, I am only here to listen." If you notice yourself wanting to steer, let it go and keep listening.

If It Isn't Working

Some kids freeze when asked what they love. Try a walk through the house instead. Point at objects and ask, "Do you like this?" Or watch what they choose for a few days and write down what you see.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MISSION 1.2

Spark To Skill

15 Minutes | You Will Need: Paper, one chosen interest

The Idea

Now take one interest from your list and ask a question that turns play into growth: “What could you get better at?” A child who loves drawing animals could learn to draw one new animal a week. A child who loves a video game could learn to design a level on paper.

The point is not to make play into schoolwork. It is to show your child that their passion can lead somewhere. Kids who feel good at something carry that feeling into harder areas.

Keep the project tiny so it feels easy to begin. One small skill is plenty.

Steps

1. Choose one interest from your list.
2. Ask: “What is one thing about this you would like to get better at?”
3. Break it into three small steps together.
4. Choose the first step and do it right now.
5. Put the plan somewhere visible, such as the fridge.

Say This

> *“What’s one thing you’d like to learn how to do with this?”*
> *“What would the first tiny step be?”*

Plan It

When Will We Try This?

What I Need To Get Ready:

MISSION 1.2 NOTES

Spark To Skill

Notice

- [ ] Whether your child chooses a goal on their own or needs ideas.
- [ ] How they react to a small, finish-able step.
- [ ] Pride when the first step is done.
- [ ] Any resistance, and what it might be telling you.

Guardian Pause

If your child picks a goal that seems too big or too odd, pause before you reply. Count to three silently, then ask "How could we make the first step smaller?" Your calm response teaches planning more than any lecture.

If It Isn't Working

If your child lacks ideas, offer two options and let them pick. Choice builds buy-in. If the goal fizzles after a day or two, that is normal. Try a different interest. The skill being built is trying.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MISSION 1.3

The Gentle Landing

10 Minutes | You Will Need: A timer you can see

The Idea

Hard stops are hard for deeply focused kids. Their brains are fully inside the activity, and a sudden "Time's up!" can feel like being yanked out of a dream.

A gentle landing replaces the yank with a runway. You give warnings, you make the ending predictable, and you tell your child what comes next. Many families find that tantrums shrink when transitions become routine rather than ambush.

Practice on a calm day first, with something low stakes. Then use it when it matters.

Steps

1. Choose a regular transition, such as screen time ending or leaving a game.
2. Give three warnings: ten minutes, five minutes and one minute.
3. Use a visual timer or a phone alarm they can see.
4. At the one-minute warning, say what comes next: "Then we wash hands for dinner."
5. When time is up, thank them for stopping. Say "Next time you can pick up right here."

Say This

> *"Ten more minutes, then we'll wrap up."*
>
> *"Time to save your place. You can come back tomorrow."*

MISSION 1.3 NOTES

The Gentle Landing

Notice

- [ ] Which warning your child responds to best.
- [ ] Whether a visual timer helps more than your voice.
- [ ] The difference between a landing with a plan and a landing without.
- [ ] How you feel when the landing goes well.

Guardian Pause

At the moment the timer rings, take a breath before you speak. Lower your voice slightly. A quieter tone is often easier to hear than a louder one, and it keeps you steady.

If It Isn't Working

If warnings are ignored, stand close and make eye contact for the last one. If your child melts down anyway, stay calm, keep the limit and skip the lecture. Talk about it later when you are both settled.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MISSION 1.4

Teach Me Time

10 Minutes | You Will Need: Your full attention

The Idea

Flip the roles. For ten minutes, your child becomes the teacher and you become a curious student. Kids with ADHD often hear what they are doing wrong all day. This mission lets them be the expert.

Teaching is also one of the best ways to understand something deeply. To explain a favourite topic, your child has to organise their thoughts, find words and check whether you are following.

Ask real questions. Resist the urge to correct or add your own facts.

Steps

1. Pick one of your child's top interests.
2. Say you would love to learn about it, and ask them to teach you for ten minutes.
3. Put your phone away and face them.
4. Ask three genuine questions, such as "Why does it work like that?"
5. End by telling them one thing you learned.

Say This

> *"I know almost nothing about this. Can you teach me?"*
> *"That's so interesting. What happens next?"*

Plan It

When Will We Try This?

What I Need To Get Ready:

MISSION 1.4 NOTES

Teach Me Time

Notice

- [ ] How your child's posture changes when they are the expert.
- [ ] Words and ideas they use that surprise you.
- [ ] Moments they check that you understand.
- [ ] How it feels to simply listen.

Guardian Pause

If your mind wanders to the to-do list, gently bring it back. Notice the thought, then return to your child's face. Attention is something you can practice, too.

If It Isn't Working

If your child gets restless after two minutes, shorten it to a quick lightning round of three questions. Or let them show you rather than tell you. Demonstrating counts as teaching.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MISSION 1.5

Focus Fort

15 Minutes | You Will Need: A quiet corner, a small timer

The Idea

A fort is more than a place to play. A defined space with a clear purpose can help a child settle into focus. In this mission you and your child set up a "mission base," a small spot with fewer distractions, then use it for a short stretch of an interest-based project.

The fort can be a blanket over chairs, a corner with cushions or a desk turned away from the busiest part of the room. What matters is that your child helps design it so it feels like theirs.

Keep sessions short at first, ten to fifteen minutes, and end on a high note.

Steps

1. Let your child choose the spot and gather supplies.
2. Remove obvious distractions together: toys, screens, clutter.
3. Set a visible timer for ten to fifteen minutes.
4. Let your child work on a chosen project from Mission 1.2.
5. When the timer ends, celebrate what got done.

Say This

> *"This is your mission base. What do you need in here?"*
>
> *"Look at everything you finished. Nice work."*

Plan It

When Will We Try This?

What I Need To Get Ready:

MISSION 1.5 NOTES

Focus Fort

Notice

- [ ] What helped your child settle in.
- [ ] How long they stayed with it.
- [ ] Signs of pride when time was up.
- [ ] What you might change next time.

Guardian Pause

While your child works, resist the urge to hover or correct. Stay nearby doing something quiet. Your calm presence is part of the fort.

If It Isn't Working

If your child cannot settle, shrink the timer to five minutes or invite them to move between work and a short stretch break. A fort that works for ten minutes is better than one forced for thirty.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MODULE 1 DEBRIEF

Look Back

Which mission worked best, and what made it work?

What did I learn about my child's interests?

What did I notice about my own patience this week?

Mission Check-Off

Done	Mission	How It Went
☐	1.1 The Interest Inventory	
☐	1.2 Spark To Skill	
☐	1.3 The Gentle Landing	
☐	1.4 Teach Me Time	
☐	1.5 Focus Fort	

MODULE 1 DEBRIEF

Look Ahead

One thing to keep doing:

One thing to change:

A small win to celebrate:

How steady did my patience feel in this module? (1 = stretched, 5 = steady)

1 2 3 4 5

A Sentence I Want To Say To My Child This Week:

A Strength I Will Watch For This Week:

MODULE 2

Active Power

From High Energy To Active Power

★ Meet The Power

Some children seem to run on a different battery. They climb the furniture, tap the table, hum while they eat and ask if you can go to the park five minutes after you got home from it.

If you are a parent of one of these children, you have probably heard the word "too." Too much, too loud, too wiggly. It is easy to start feeling that your child's energy is a problem to be managed.

Here is another way to see it. Energy is fuel. Athletes, performers, builders and entrepreneurs all rely on it. The same drive that bounces off the walls at 7 p.m. can power a long hike, a school play or a first job on a busy shift. Many parents notice their child seems to think better after moving, not just after burning off steam.

The trouble is not the energy itself. It is when and where it shows up. A classroom, a car seat and a dinner table all ask for stillness, and that can be a real stretch.

This module does not try to shrink your child's energy. It gives it better places to go. You will map when your child's energy peaks, build movement into the day and create a wind-down routine that lets the body settle.

For you, patience here means tolerating motion. You will practice letting a wiggle be a wiggle, and picking your battles about what truly needs to be still.

★ **Energy is not the enemy. It just needs a place to go.** ★

★ Trait Map

What You See	What It Can Grow Into	Where It Trips You Up	Sidekick Tool
Always moving	Stamina and drive	Hard to sit at meals or in class	Planned movement breaks
Fidgets constantly	Thinks better in motion	Others see it as not listening	Quiet fidget or standing option
Loud, bouncy play	Enthusiasm and leadership	Overwhelms quieter settings	Outdoor or active time before quiet time
Struggles to wind down	Full-on engagement	Bedtime battles	A calm, repeating wind-down routine

⏸ Patience Check-In

When does your child's energy get on your nerves the most? What is going on for you at that time of day?

Where could you let the movement happen instead of fighting it?

MISSION 2.1

The Energy Map

10 Minutes A Day For 3 Days | You Will Need: Chart in this book

The Idea

Before you plan anything, find out what is actually happening. Energy is rarely random. Most children have times when it peaks, times when it dips and moments when a small change makes a big difference.

For three days, jot down quick notes at set points in the day. You are looking for patterns, not perfection. A map like this helps you schedule hard tasks when your child is most ready and plan movement before the moments that ask for stillness.

Keep it light. Two minutes a time is plenty.

Steps

1. Choose three check-in times, such as before school, after school and before bed.
2. At each time, rate your child's energy from 1 (low) to 5 (very high).
3. Note what happened just before and what helped or hurt.
4. After three days, look for patterns together if your child is willing.
5. Circle the best time for focus tasks and the best time for active play.

Say This

> *"I'm noticing when you have the most energy. When do you feel most ready to run?"*
>
> *"When do you feel most tired or grumpy?"*

MISSION 2.1 NOTES

The Energy Map

Notice

- [ ] Times of day with high energy and good mood.
- [ ] Times when energy is high but things go badly.
- [ ] Effects of food, sleep and activity on the day.
- [ ] Surprising patterns.

Guardian Pause

If a low-energy moment makes you worry, remind yourself that every child has them. Take a breath and record what you see without adding a story to it. Facts first, then conclusions.

If It Isn't Working

If you forget to check in, set a phone reminder. If three days feels like too much, track one day to start. Even one day of notes tells you more than guessing.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MISSION 2.2

Move, Then Think

10 Minutes | You Will Need: Space to move

The Idea

Many kids settle into a seated task better after moving first. Two to five minutes of active play before homework or a quiet activity can make sitting feel more doable.

This mission is a simple experiment. You will try a short burst of movement before a seated task and see what changes. Make it fun so it does not feel like a chore.

Keep the movement short and playful: jumping jacks, a dance, a lap around the garden, a game of animal walks.

Steps

1. Pick a task that requires sitting, such as homework or reading.
2. Choose a two-to-five minute movement game together.
3. Move with your child. Your participation matters.
4. Take one slow breath together when the movement ends.
5. Start the task and notice how your child settles.

Say This

> *"Let's get our wiggles out first. Pick a move."*
> *"Ready? Big breath, then let's begin."*

Plan It

When Will We Try This?

What I Need To Get Ready:

MISSION 2.2 NOTES

Move, Then Think

Notice

- [ ] How long your child stays on task after movement.
- [ ] Which kind of movement works best.
- [ ] Whether the transition back to sitting is smooth.
- [ ] How you feel after moving too.

Guardian Pause

Join in even if you feel silly. When you are doing star jumps beside a laughing child, patience is easier to find. Joy and calm are close neighbours.

If It Isn't Working

If movement winds your child up instead of settling them, switch to slower options like stretching or pushing against a wall. Try different types until you find a good match.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MISSION 2.3

The Mission Circuit

15 Minutes | You Will Need: Household items

The Idea

An indoor or outdoor obstacle course turns movement into a game. Add a learning task at each station, such as spelling a word, counting jumps or naming a feeling, and you combine energy with thinking.

Build the circuit from things you already have: cushions to hop between, a line of tape to walk, a chair to crawl under, a laundry basket to toss socks into. Let your child help design it.

Keep it safe, clear and short. Three to five stations is plenty.

Steps

1. Choose a safe space and clear anything breakable.
2. Build three to five stations with your child.
3. Add one small challenge at each station.
4. Run the circuit together, timing the first run.
5. Let your child redesign it and go again.

Say This

> *"Let's build a mission course. What's the first challenge?"*
> *"How could we make it harder?"*

Plan It

When Will We Try This?

What I Need To Get Ready:

MISSION 2.3 NOTES

The Mission Circuit

Notice

- [ ] Ideas your child comes up with.
- [ ] How they cope with waiting their turn.
- [ ] Signs of pride at finishing.
- [ ] How you handle noise and mess.

Guardian Pause

A noisy circuit tests patience. Before you begin, decide what level of mess is acceptable, and say it out loud. Setting your limit in advance saves you from snapping in the middle.

If It Isn't Working

If space is tight, use a hallway or a small corner and scale it down. If your child loses interest, switch to a timed challenge or add a prize like picking the next game.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MISSION 2.4

Big Helper Jobs

10 Minutes | You Will Need: A task to do

The Idea

Some of the best ways to use energy are real jobs. Carrying, pushing, pulling and lifting tasks give a child's energy a purpose, and being needed builds confidence.

Choose jobs that suit your child's age and are safe: carrying groceries, wiping the table, watering plants, stacking firewood, pushing the laundry basket, taking out the recycling. Frame them as important missions, because they are.

The goal is not free labour. It is to show your child that their strength is useful.

Steps

1. Choose two or three age-appropriate jobs together.
2. Explain why the job matters to the family.
3. Show how to do it safely, then step back.
4. Thank them specifically afterward: "You carried every bag. That saved me a lot of time."
5. Add a job to your weekly routine if it went well.

Say This

> *"I need a strong helper for a mission. Are you in?"*
> *"That was a big help. Thank you for carrying that."*

Plan It

When Will We Try This?

What I Need To Get Ready:

MISSION 2.4 NOTES

Big Helper Jobs

Notice

- [ ] Which jobs your child enjoys most.
- [ ] How they stand taller after being thanked.
- [ ] Whether doing a job helps them settle afterward.
- [ ] How it feels when you let them do it their way.

Guardian Pause

Kids rarely do chores as perfectly as adults would. Take a breath and choose to value effort over finish. You can fix the corner later, privately, or not at all.

If It Isn't Working

If your child resists, make it a team job and do it side by side. Turn on music or race a timer. If the job is too hard, scale it down until they win.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MISSION 2.5

The Wind-Down Ritual

10 Minutes | You Will Need: A quiet corner

The Idea

After a day of high energy, bodies need help to slow down. A short, repeating routine in the same order every night signals that it is time to settle. Predictability is soothing, and it takes pressure off you to invent a new plan each evening.

Include a few slow steps: dimming lights, stretching, a few deep breaths, a quiet story. Let your child choose the order so it feels like theirs.

Practice during the day first so the routine is familiar when you need it.

Steps

1. Choose three or four calming steps with your child.
2. Write or draw them in order on a card.
3. Try the sequence together, slowly.
4. Use the same cues each evening: lights lower, voices softer.
5. Praise any effort to slow down, even small.

Say This

> *"It's wind-down time. What's our first step?"*
> *"Let's take three slow breaths together."*

Plan It

When Will We Try This?

What I Need To Get Ready:

MISSION 2.5 NOTES

The Wind-Down Ritual

Notice

- [ ] Which steps help your child relax most.
- [ ] How long the wind-down takes.
- [ ] Changes in the mood of the evening.
- [ ] Whether you settle too.

Guardian Pause

Evenings are tiring for you as well. Do the breathing with your child and let your shoulders drop. You are not just guiding them; you are resetting yourself.

If It Isn't Working

If it takes too long, keep it to two steps for a week, then add more. If bedtime battles continue, focus on consistency over perfection and try again with fewer demands.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MODULE 2 DEBRIEF

Look Back

Which mission worked best, and what made it work?

What did I learn about when my child's energy peaks?

What did I notice about my own patience this week?

Mission Check-Off

Done	Mission	How It Went
☐	2.1 The Energy Map	
☐	2.2 Move, Then Think	
☐	2.3 The Mission Circuit	
☐	2.4 Big Helper Jobs	
☐	2.5 The Wind-Down Ritual	

MODULE 2 DEBRIEF

Look Ahead

One thing to keep doing:

One thing to change:

A small win to celebrate:

How steady did my patience feel in this module? (1 = stretched, 5 = steady)

1 2 3 4 5

A Sentence I Want To Say To My Child This Week:

A Strength I Will Watch For This Week:

MODULE 3

Spark Ideas

From Impulsive Thinking To Creative Thinking

★ Meet The Power

Ideas arrive fast in your child's mind. One minute they are designing a rocket, the next they are inventing a new game, and before you can answer they have a third plan that involves the dog.

Quick, jumping thoughts can be exhausting for parents. They can also be the raw material of creativity. Many creative people describe minds that make unusual connections and see possibilities others miss. Your child's brain may be doing exactly that.

The same speed has a downside. Acting on an idea before thinking it through can lead to spills, arguments, broken things and hurt feelings. Blurting out answers, interrupting and diving in without a plan are common for kids who think fast.

This module does not aim to slow the ideas down. It teaches a three-part habit: spark, plan, go. Your child keeps the creativity and adds a short pause before action. You will practice the pause through games, so it feels like play rather than correction.

For you, patience means welcoming the flood of ideas without feeling you must act on each one. You can say "Great idea, let's save it" and still keep your evening on track.

★ **A fast mind needs a good catcher's mitt, not a brake.** ★

★ Trait Map

What You See	What It Can Grow Into	Where It Trips You Up	Sidekick Tool
Ideas pour out nonstop	Creativity and invention	Starts many things, finishes few	Idea Jar to catch and save ideas
Acts before thinking	Bold, quick decisions	Accidents and arguments	Stop-Think-Go signal
Interrupts or blurts	Eager, enthusiastic voice	Conversations feel one-sided	Practice turn-taking in play
Jumps between projects	Wide range of interests	Unfinished work piles up	Two-Minute Plan before starting

⏸ Patience Check-In

What is the most creative idea your child has had lately? How did you respond in the moment?

How could you respond next time so the idea feels welcome even if you cannot do it?

MISSION 3.1

The Idea Jar

10 Minutes | You Will Need: A jar, paper, pens

The Idea

When ideas are valued, kids share them. When they are brushed aside, kids stop offering. An Idea Jar gives every spark a home so it is never lost, and so you can say "yes, save it" instead of "not now."

Decorate a jar together. Whenever your child has an idea, they write or draw it on a slip of paper and drop it in. Once a week, pull out a few slips and choose one to try.

The jar teaches an important skill: ideas can wait without disappearing.

Steps

1. Find a jar or box and let your child decorate it.
2. Cut paper into small slips and keep a pen nearby.
3. Explain: "When you have an idea, we put it in the jar so it stays safe."
4. Write down the first idea together right away.
5. Once a week, choose one to try as a family.

Say This

> *"That's a great idea. Let's put it in the jar so we don't lose it."*
> *"Which idea from the jar should we try this weekend?"*

Plan It

When Will We Try This?

What I Need To Get Ready:

MISSION 3.1 NOTES

The Idea Jar

Notice

- [ ] How your child reacts when an idea gets saved.
- [ ] The kinds of ideas that appear.
- [ ] Whether waiting feels easier with the jar.
- [ ] The ideas that you can actually make happen.

Guardian Pause

When your child shares an idea at an inconvenient moment, take a slow breath before you reply. “Jar it” can become a calm phrase for both of you.

If It Isn’t Working

If your child forgets to use the jar, keep slips and a pen in the car or by the table. If the jar overflows, pick three favourites and let the rest go without guilt.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MISSION 3.2

Yes, And Stories

10 Minutes | You Will Need: Imagination

The Idea

Building a story together is a playful way to practice listening, turn-taking and building on another person's ideas. The rule is simple: every contribution starts with "Yes, and..."

Fast thinkers love this game because their ideas are welcome. They also practice waiting for their turn and connecting their thought to someone else's, which makes conversations easier.

Keep it silly. A story about a dragon who is afraid of homework is a perfect start.

Steps

1. Choose a starting sentence, such as "One day a very small elephant found a key."
2. Take turns adding one sentence each, starting with "Yes, and..."
3. Keep going for five to ten minutes.
4. If your child interrupts, gently signal it is your turn and thank them for waiting.
5. End by reading the story back and choosing a title.

Say This

> *"Yes, and then the elephant opened the door."*
>
> *"I loved your idea. My turn to add one."*

MISSION 3.2 NOTES

Yes, And Stories

Notice

- [ ] How your child handles waiting for their turn.
- [ ] Whether they build on your idea or replace it.
- [ ] Funny moments you want to remember.
- [ ] How you feel being playful together.

Guardian Pause

Let the story go in an odd direction. You are not editing; you are playing. Notice any urge to correct, take a breath and say "Yes, and..."

If It Isn't Working

If turns are hard, use a toy as a talking stick: only the person holding it speaks. If the story stalls, ask a question like "What happens next?"

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MISSION 3.3

Stop-Think-Go

10 Minutes | You Will Need: Open space

The Idea

A pause is a skill, and skills grow through practice. This game works like a traffic light: green means move, yellow means slow down and red means freeze. Playing it builds the body-brain habit of stopping before acting.

Play it as a game with no pressure and plenty of laughter. Take turns being the light so your child gets to control you too.

Over time you can use the same words in real life: "Yellow light. What's the plan?"

Steps

1. Explain the colours: green is go, yellow is slow, red is stop.
2. Call colours while your child moves around the room.
3. Add silly versions: green means hop, yellow means tiptoe.
4. Swap roles and let your child be the traffic light.
5. After a few rounds, ask: "What did you notice about stopping fast?"

Say This

> *"Green light! Go go go."*
> *"Yellow light. Slow your body down."*

Plan It

When Will We Try This?

What I Need To Get Ready:

MISSION 3.3 NOTES

Stop-Think-Go

Notice

- [ ] How quickly your child responds to “red.”
- [ ] Whether they enjoy being the light.
- [ ] Moments they stop without being told.
- [ ] Any frustration and how you respond.

Guardian Pause

When you are the one who is moving, you also practice stopping. Pay attention to how it feels to freeze on “red.” That small pause is the same one you use before you speak sharply.

If It Isn’t Working

If it feels babyish, make it a faster game with a timer or add silly challenges. For older kids, use it as a “pause button” joke in everyday life.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MISSION 3.4

The Build-It Challenge

15 Minutes | You Will Need: Household items

The Idea

Building with ordinary items gives your child's creativity somewhere real to go. Hand over a pile of boxes, tape, cups and paper, and set a simple challenge: build a bridge, a tower, a boat that floats or a marble run.

The best part comes after the build. Ask what worked, what failed and what they would change. This is the heart of invention: try, test, fix. It also shows that mistakes are part of making things.

Keep your hands back and let your child lead.

Steps

1. Gather safe materials such as cardboard, tape, cups and string.
2. Choose a challenge, such as "Build something that can hold a toy car."
3. Set a timer for ten minutes and let your child build.
4. Test the creation together.
5. Ask: "What would you change next time?"

Say This

> *"What are you building? Tell me about it."*
> *"What do you want to try differently?"*

Plan It

When Will We Try This?

What I Need To Get Ready:

MISSION 3.4 NOTES

The Build-It Challenge

Notice

- [ ] How your child reacts when something doesn't work.
- [ ] Creative solutions that surprise you.
- [ ] Whether they plan before building or jump right in.
- [ ] How hard it is for you not to help.

Guardian Pause

If the structure collapses, resist the urge to fix it or say "I told you so." Take a slow breath and say, "Interesting. What happened?"

If It Isn't Working

If your child gets frustrated, shrink the challenge or build alongside them. If they lose interest, switch to a new material or let them choose the challenge.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MISSION 3.5

The Two-Minute Plan

10 Minutes | You Will Need: Paper, pen

The Idea

Spark, plan, go. The two-minute plan sits in the middle. Before your child starts a new idea, they spend two minutes naming three steps and the things they will need. Two minutes is short enough to feel doable and long enough to catch problems.

Start with something fun, like baking cookies or building a den. Make the plan together, then follow it. Afterwards, ask whether the plan helped.

Over time, the habit can spread to bigger tasks, such as homework and cleaning.

Steps

1. Choose a project your child is excited about.
2. Ask: "What are the first three steps?" Write them down.
3. Ask: "What will you need?" List the items.
4. Set a two-minute timer to gather supplies.
5. Do the project, then talk about how the plan helped.

Say This

> *"Great idea. What are the first three steps?"*
>
> *"What do we need before we start?"*

Plan It

When Will We Try This?

What I Need To Get Ready:

MISSION 3.5 NOTES

The Two-Minute Plan

Notice

- [ ] Whether the plan saves time or frustration.
- [ ] How easily your child makes the plan.
- [ ] Steps they skip or add.
- [ ] How the project felt compared with last time.

Guardian Pause

If your child resists the plan, take a breath. Remind yourself that you are teaching a habit, not controlling the outcome. Try again next time with a lighter touch.

If It Isn't Working

If planning feels like a chore, draw it as a comic strip with three panels. If your child jumps in before the plan, laugh, reset and try again.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MODULE 3 DEBRIEF

Look Back

Which mission worked best, and what made it work?

What did I learn about my child's creative side?

What did I notice about my own patience this week?

Mission Check-Off

Done	Mission	How It Went
☐	3.1 The Idea Jar	
☐	3.2 Yes, And Stories	
☐	3.3 Stop-Think-Go	
☐	3.4 The Build-It Challenge	
☐	3.5 The Two-Minute Plan	

MODULE 3 DEBRIEF

Look Ahead

One thing to keep doing:

One thing to change:

A small win to celebrate:

How steady did my patience feel in this module? (1 = stretched, 5 = steady)

1 2 3 4 5

A Sentence I Want To Say To My Child This Week:

A Strength I Will Watch For This Week:

MODULE 4

Big Heart

From Big Feelings To Big Heart

★ Meet The Power

Joy that fills the room. Anger that arrives like a thunderclap. Tears over a broken crayon. Many kids with ADHD feel things strongly and show them quickly, with little filter between the feeling and the reaction.

This can be hard to live with. You may find yourself walking on eggshells or wondering whether the next outburst is around the corner. You may also feel guilt after you lose your own temper in response.

There is another side. Strong feelings often come with strong empathy. Many of these children are the first to notice when a friend is sad, the first to hug a hurt pet, the loudest in their love. A big heart is a gift to the people around it.

The challenge is helping the feelings settle into words and actions your child can manage. That is a skill, and skills are learned slowly, through repetition and kindness. It is not a matter of willpower, and shame makes it harder.

This module gives you simple ways to build feelings vocabulary, make a calm space and repair after a rough moment. Your child learns that feelings are information, not enemies.

For you, this is the patience heartland. Calm is contagious. When you stay steady, your child borrows your steadiness until they can build their own.

★ **Calm is contagious. Lend yours first.** ★

★ Trait Map

What You See	What It Can Grow Into	Where It Trips You Up	Sidekick Tool
Feels everything deeply	Empathy and warmth	Overwhelm and meltdowns	Feelings vocabulary and check-ins
Quick to anger or tears	Passion and honesty	Reactions bigger than the problem	Calm Corner and breathing games
Struggles to explain feelings	Open, expressive nature	Frustration when not understood	Feeling Detective and drawing
Hard to recover after upset	Deep caring about relationships	Lingering guilt or shame	Repair and Reconnect routine

⏸ Patience Check-In

Think of the last big feeling moment in your home. What did your child need underneath the behaviour? What did you need?

What would you like to do differently the next time?

MISSION 4.1

Feelings Weather Report

5 Minutes A Day | You Will Need: Paper, markers

The Idea

Weather is something kids understand. It changes, it can be sunny or stormy, and nobody is to blame for it. Describing feelings as weather makes them easier to talk about and less scary.

Once a day, ask your child for a weather report. "Sunny with a few clouds." "Thunderstorm in my tummy." Then offer yours. Over days, you both build a habit of noticing feelings before they explode.

Keep it light and brief. There are no wrong answers.

Steps

1. Draw or print simple weather symbols: sun, cloud, rain, storm, rainbow.
2. At a regular time, ask: "What's your feeling weather today?"
3. Let your child point or say it, with no judgment.
4. Share your own weather honestly.
5. Ask one gentle question: "Is there anything that would help the weather?"

Say This

> *"What's your inside weather right now?"*
> *"Mine is cloudy with a little sunshine. What helps you on stormy days?"*

Plan It

When Will We Try This?

What I Need To Get Ready:

MISSION 4.1 NOTES

Feelings Weather Report

Notice

- [ ] Whether your child chooses words or pictures.
- [ ] Patterns in the weather across the week.
- [ ] How your child responds when you share yours.
- [ ] Which times are sunnier or stormier.

Guardian Pause

When your child reports a storm, resist the urge to fix it or talk them out of it. Take a breath and say, “Thanks for telling me.” Naming comes before solving.

If It Isn’t Working

If your child shrugs, offer two choices: “More sunny or more stormy?” Or draw faces instead of weather. Keep it short and try again tomorrow.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MISSION 4.2

Feeling Detective

15 Minutes | You Will Need: Paper, pencils

The Idea

Many children feel a lot but have few words for it. “Mad” gets used for frustrated, disappointed, embarrassed and worried. A larger vocabulary helps them tell you what is really going on.

In this mission you become detectives together. Look for clues about feelings in faces, in stories and in your own day. Name the clue and the feeling, then guess what might help.

You are not diagnosing. You are collecting words.

Steps

1. Draw four or five simple faces together, such as happy, sad, angry, nervous and proud.
2. Add a new feeling word to each: excited, disappointed, frustrated, embarrassed.
3. Look at a book, show or photo and ask what the character might feel.
4. Ask: “What clues tell you that?”
5. Share a time you felt one of the feelings.

Say This

> *“What clues tell you he’s feeling that way?”*
>
> *“Have you ever felt like that? What did it feel like in your body?”*

MISSION 4.2 NOTES

Feeling Detective

Notice

- ☐ Feelings words your child already knows.
- ☐ Where in the body they say feelings show up.
- ☐ How willing they are to connect to their own life.
- ☐ Words that become part of your family vocabulary.

Guardian Pause

Share a small, honest moment from your own day, like feeling rushed or disappointed. Modelling that adults have feelings too is powerful. Keep it calm and short.

If It Isn't Working

If your child resists, make it a guessing game about characters and leave their own feelings out for now. Or use emoji or a feelings poster as a visual aid.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MISSION 4.3

The Calm Corner Kit

20 Minutes | You Will Need: A box or basket, small items

The Idea

A calm corner is a place to reset, never a punishment. It gives your child a safe spot to settle big feelings, with tools they chose themselves. When the corner is built on a good day, it is far easier to use on a bad one.

Fill a box with soothing items: a soft toy, a stress ball, headphones, paper and crayons, a bottle of glitter water, a few calming cards. Let your child decorate it.

Practise using it together before you need it.

Steps

1. Choose a quiet corner or a spot that feels safe.
2. Give your child a box or basket and invite them to choose what goes inside.
3. Add a card listing three calming steps they like.
4. Practice a pretend big feeling and use the corner together.
5. Agree that either of you may use it when needed.

Say This

> *"This is your calm place. You decide what goes in it."*
>
> *"Would you like to go to your corner, or would you like me to sit with you?"*

Plan It

When Will We Try This?

What I Need To Get Ready:

MISSION 4.3 NOTES

The Calm Corner Kit

Notice

- ☐ Items your child picks.
- ☐ How long they stay in the corner when calm.
- ☐ Whether they use it on their own over time.
- ☐ How it feels for you to use it, too.

Guardian Pause

Make yourself a mini Calm Corner Kit. One small item that settles you, like a scented hand cream or a favourite song, can help you stay steady during hard moments.

If It Isn't Working

If your child avoids the corner, make sure it never feels like a time-out. Invite them to use it with you at first. Keep it free of screens if possible.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MISSION 4.4

Breathing Games

10 Minutes | You Will Need: Your own two lungs

The Idea

Slow breathing is a simple tool that nearly anyone can learn. For children, it works best as a game with a silly name. When a big feeling arrives, a familiar breathing game can give the body a chance to settle.

Try a few and let your child choose the favourites. Practise when things are calm so the skill is ready when needed.

Think of it as a pause button. A slow breath out gives you both a moment to choose what happens next.

Steps

1. Try "smell the flower, blow the candle": a slow breath in through the nose, a slow breath out through the mouth.
2. Try "balloon belly": place a hand on the tummy and watch it rise and fall.
3. Try "five-finger breathing": trace each finger as you breathe in and out.
4. Pick your favourite and practise three rounds together.
5. Agree on a signal that means "let's breathe."

Say This

> *"Let's smell the flower and blow the candle."*
>
> *"Which breathing game do you want to use today?"*

Plan It

When Will We Try This?

What I Need To Get Ready:

MISSION 4.4 NOTES

Breathing Games

Notice

- [ ] Which game your child picks first.
- [ ] Whether they can slow their breathing.
- [ ] Giggles or silliness, which are fine.
- [ ] Whether you feel calmer, too.

Guardian Pause

Breathe along with your child, and make your out-breath slower than your in-breath. The best time to practise is when you do not need it, so these two minutes are a gift to your future self.

If It Isn't Working

If breathing feels hard or your child gets dizzy, stop and do something else, like squeezing a cushion. If they find it boring, add a toy to watch rise and fall.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MISSION 4.5

Repair And Reconnect

10 Minutes | You Will Need: A calm moment after an upset

The Idea

Every parent loses their cool sometimes. Every child has meltdowns. What matters most is what happens afterward. Repair is the act of coming back together after a rupture.

Wait until everyone is calm. Then reconnect: acknowledge what happened, take responsibility for your part, listen and say what you will try next time. Repair teaches kids that relationships survive hard moments, and that mistakes can be fixed.

You do not need perfect words. Warmth matters more.

Steps

1. Wait until you and your child are calm.
2. Offer a hug, a sit-down or an activity, whatever suits them.
3. Say what you noticed: “Earlier we both got upset.”
4. Own your part: “I raised my voice. I’m sorry.”
5. Ask: “What could help next time?” and listen.

Say This

> *“I’m sorry I yelled. I want to do better. Can we try again?”*
> *“What do you need from me when you feel like that?”*

Plan It

When Will We Try This?

What I Need To Get Ready:

MISSION 4.5 NOTES

Repair And Reconnect

Notice

- [ ] How your child responds to an apology.
- [ ] Ideas they offer for next time.
- [ ] How your own body feels after repairing.
- [ ] Whether the relationship feels warmer.

Guardian Pause

Say sorry without a "but." "I'm sorry I yelled" is complete. Add nothing that sounds like an excuse. Notice how it feels to let your shoulders down.

If It Isn't Working

If your child is not ready to talk, say "I'm here when you're ready" and leave it. Offer repair through action, such as making a snack or sitting nearby. Try again later.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MODULE 4 DEBRIEF

Look Back

Which mission worked best, and what made it work?

What did I learn about how my child feels and shows feelings?

What did I notice about my own patience this week?

Mission Check-Off

Done	Mission	How It Went
☐	4.1 Feelings Weather Report	
☐	4.2 Feeling Detective	
☐	4.3 The Calm Corner Kit	
☐	4.4 Breathing Games	
☐	4.5 Repair And Reconnect	

MODULE 4 DEBRIEF

Look Ahead

One thing to keep doing:

One thing to change:

A small win to celebrate:

How steady did my patience feel in this module? (1 = stretched, 5 = steady)

1 2 3 4 5

A Sentence I Want To Say To My Child This Week:

A Strength I Will Watch For This Week:

MODULE 5

Wide Radar

From Distractibility To Curiosity

★ Meet The Power

You ask your child to put on their shoes. Five minutes later they are at the window watching a bird, with one shoe on and a long story about the bird's nest.

It is easy to read this as not listening. Another reading is that your child's attention is wide open. They notice the bird, the new sound from next door, the loose thread on your sleeve. Their radar picks up everything.

A wide radar can be a real strength. People who notice a lot make good artists, scientists, detectives, first responders and storytellers. They spot what others miss. Curiosity can shape careers and friendships for a lifetime.

The difficulty is that radar does not come with a filter. When a task is dull or the room is busy, it is hard to choose what to focus on. Instructions get lost. Time slips by.

This module treats noticing as a skill to be proud of, and then gives it a direction. Your child practises paying attention on purpose, in short and playful bursts. They learn that curiosity is welcome, and that they can steer it.

For you, patience means making room for detours. Not every tangent needs stopping. Some can be followed for five minutes and turned into learning.

★ **A child who notices everything has the makings of a very good observer.** ★

★ Trait Map

What You See	What It Can Grow Into	Where It Trips You Up	Sidekick Tool
Notices tiny details	Observation and insight	Misses the main instruction	Short, one-step requests with eye contact
Easily drawn off task	Curiosity and wide interests	Unfinished tasks	Tangent Time with a time limit
Asks endless questions	Love of learning	Hard to answer at busy moments	Question of the Day
Forgets what you just said	Lives in the moment	Missed steps and repeated reminders	Say, show, check

⏸ Patience Check-In

When did your child's wandering attention last frustrate you? Looking back, what did they notice that you missed?

How could you welcome the noticing and still get the shoes on?

MISSION 5.1

The Five Senses Walk

15 Minutes | You Will Need: Outdoors or a room

The Idea

Take your child's wide radar for a walk. A five senses walk is an easy way to turn noticing into a game. You are not testing them. You are exploring together.

Walk around the garden, the street or even the house. Stop at each sense and share what you find: something you see, hear, feel, smell and, if safe, taste. The aim is to show that paying attention can be interesting, not just a demand.

Keep it short and end while it is still fun.

Steps

1. Choose a place to walk, inside or out.
2. Start with sight: "Find three things you've never noticed before."
3. Move on to sound, touch and smell, one at a time.
4. Take turns sharing what you notice.
5. Finish by asking: "What was your favourite discovery?"

Say This

> *"Let's be explorers. What can you hear right now?"*
> *"I never noticed that before. Good eye."*

Plan It

When Will We Try This?

What I Need To Get Ready:

MISSION 5.1 NOTES

The Five Senses Walk

Notice

- [ ] Details your child spots that you missed.
- [ ] Which sense they enjoy most.
- [ ] How long they stay engaged.
- [ ] How you feel when you slow down and notice too.

Guardian Pause

Slow your own pace. Let your child lead when they stop to look at something. Practising presence yourself will make you more patient with their wandering.

If It Isn't Working

If your child rushes, give a specific challenge like "Find something rough." If they tire quickly, shorten the walk to one sense per day.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MISSION 5.2

Notice And Name

10 Minutes | You Will Need: A busy picture or a room

The Idea

This is a variation on "I spy" with a focus on detail. You ask your child to look carefully and describe what they see, using specific words: colours, shapes, positions and how things might feel.

The game builds the habit of looking closely and putting thoughts into words, which supports listening and storytelling later. It also lets your child shine at something they are naturally good at.

Use a picture book page, a photo or the room you are sitting in.

Steps

1. Choose a busy picture or look around the room.
2. Take turns saying "I notice..." and naming one detail.
3. Challenge each other to find details that are small, hidden or unusual.
4. Count how many you can find in two minutes.
5. Celebrate with a high five.

Say This

> *"I notice something blue under the table. What do you notice?"*
> *"How did you spot that? I missed it."*

Plan It

When Will We Try This?

What I Need To Get Ready:

MISSION 5.2 NOTES

Notice And Name

Notice

- [ ] The kinds of details your child chooses.
- [ ] Whether they use descriptive words.
- [ ] How competitive or cooperative they are.
- [ ] Your own habit of skimming past details.

Guardian Pause

Let your child win some rounds. Take a breath and notice how it feels to be impressed by them. Their strength is real.

If It Isn't Working

If the game turns into a squabble, play together as a team against the clock. If it is too easy, add rules like only things that are round.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MISSION 5.3

Tangent Time

10 Minutes | You Will Need: A timer, curiosity

The Idea

Tangents are not always distractions. They are often where learning happens. Instead of fighting them, schedule them. Tangent Time is a short window each day when your child may follow any question or idea, with you as a willing guide.

Setting a limit helps both of you. Your child knows their curiosity is welcome. You know when it ends. Many families find that when tangents have a place, they interrupt less.

Use a timer and be present for the whole stretch.

Steps

1. Agree on a daily Tangent Time, ten minutes is plenty.
2. Ask your child to choose a question they are wondering about.
3. Look it up, draw it, act it out or talk about it.
4. Stop when the timer rings, and write the question in a notebook to revisit.
5. Ask a follow-up the next day.

Say This

> *"It's Tangent Time. What are you curious about?"*
>
> *"Great question. Let's save the rest for tomorrow."*

Plan It

When Will We Try This?

What I Need To Get Ready:

MISSION 5.3 NOTES

Tangent Time

Notice

- [ ] Topics your child chooses.
- [ ] How they respond when the timer ends.
- [ ] Whether tangents during the rest of the day reduce.
- [ ] Questions you did not know the answer to.

Guardian Pause

When a tangent pops up at a bad moment, say "Save it for Tangent Time" calmly and mean it. Practise offering that response without a sigh.

If It Isn't Working

If your child struggles to stop, use a gentle landing from Module 1. If they cannot pick a topic, offer a jar of question slips to draw from.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MISSION 5.4

Spot The Change

10 Minutes | You Will Need: Small household items

The Idea

Spot the Change is a memory and observation game. You arrange a small collection of items, your child studies it, closes their eyes and you change one thing. They have to spot what is different.

The game practises focused attention in a playful, low-stakes way. It also gives you a chance to see how your child's attention works at its best.

Start easy, with five items and one change, and build up gradually.

Steps

1. Arrange five small items on a tray or table.
2. Give your child ten seconds to look carefully.
3. Ask them to close their eyes while you change one thing.
4. Let them open their eyes and find the change.
5. Swap roles and let them be the one who changes it.

Say This

> *"Look carefully. I'm going to change something."*
>
> *"You found it. What clue did you notice?"*

Plan It

When Will We Try This?

What I Need To Get Ready:

MISSION 5.4 NOTES

Spot The Change

Notice

- [ ] How quickly they spot changes.
- [ ] Strategies they use, such as scanning left to right.
- [ ] Their delight when they trick you.
- [ ] Whether they get discouraged if they miss one.

Guardian Pause

When you are the one guessing, let yourself get it wrong sometimes. Laugh at your mistakes. Showing that errors are fun can lighten the room for everyone.

If It Isn't Working

If it is too hard, use fewer items or make the change obvious. If it is too easy, add more items or change two things.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MISSION 5.5

Radar To Mission

10 Minutes | You Will Need: Your daily life

The Idea

The best use of a wide radar is to help others. This mission turns noticing into kindness. Ask your child to spot one person or thing that needs help today, then do something small about it.

It might be a neighbour's dropped letter, a sibling who looks sad, a plant that needs water or a pet that has no fresh water. Kids who feel helpful feel capable, and capable kids are more willing to try hard things.

Celebrate the noticing as much as the helping.

Steps

1. In the morning, say: "Today your mission is to spot someone or something that needs help."
2. Let your child choose what they notice.
3. Help them decide on one small action.
4. Do it together or let them do it alone.
5. In the evening, ask how it felt.

Say This

> *"Your radar is great at finding things. What did you notice today?"*
>
> *"You saw that and helped. That's a hero move."*

Plan It

When Will We Try This?

What I Need To Get Ready:

MISSION 5.5 NOTES

Radar To Mission

Notice

- [ ] What your child chooses to notice.
- [ ] How they respond to helping.
- [ ] Their mood afterward.
- [ ] Chances for more helping in the week ahead.

Guardian Pause

Name the strength out loud: "You noticed. That's a real skill." Hearing it said calmly and specifically matters more than any reward.

If It Isn't Working

If your child cannot find anything, point them in a direction like "I think the cat might be hungry." Over time they will find their own. Never force it.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MODULE 5 DEBRIEF

Look Back

Which mission worked best, and what made it work?

What did my child notice that I would have missed?

What did I notice about my own patience this week?

Mission Check-Off

Done	Mission	How It Went
☐	5.1 The Five Senses Walk	
☐	5.2 Notice And Name	
☐	5.3 Tangent Time	
☐	5.4 Spot The Change	
☐	5.5 Radar To Mission	

MODULE 5 DEBRIEF

Look Ahead

One thing to keep doing:

One thing to change:

A small win to celebrate:

How steady did my patience feel in this module? (1 = stretched, 5 = steady)

1 2 3 4 5

A Sentence I Want To Say To My Child This Week:

A Strength I Will Watch For This Week:

MODULE 6

Sidekick Systems

From Forgetfulness To Reliable Routines

★ Meet The Power

Every hero has a sidekick, a trusted helper who covers the gaps. For many kids with ADHD, the best sidekick is not a person at all. It is a system.

Forgotten lunchboxes, lost shoes, half-finished chores and endless reminders are everyday life in many homes. It can feel as though you have said the same thing a thousand times. It helps to remember that remembering is hard when attention is busy elsewhere. Your child is not ignoring you on purpose.

Where memory slips, structure can help. Visual routines, set places for things and small steps all take pressure off the brain. A checklist on the wall does the remembering so your child's mind is free for other things.

And here is the strength inside the struggle: when children help design their own systems, they build planning and problem-solving skills they will use all their lives. Kids who have learned to build their own sidekick systems often become adults who are resourceful and organised in their own way.

This module is practical. Each mission sets up one small system. Start with just one or two, and give them time to settle before adding more.

For you, patience means trading reminders for routines. It takes more effort at first, but it saves you from being the human alarm clock.

★ **Where memory slips, structure can catch.** ★

★ Trait Map

What You See	What It Can Grow Into	Where It Trips You Up	Sidekick Tool
Forgets steps of a routine	Inventive problem solver	Mornings turn chaotic	Picture routine on the wall
Loses belongings	A mind on bigger things	Missing shoes, bags, homework	A home for everything
Overwhelmed by big tasks	Capable in small steps	Room-cleaning battles	One-step cards
Loses track of time	Fully present in the moment	Late and rushed	Visual timer and clear cues

⏸ Patience Check-In

What do you remind your child of most often? How do you feel when you say it for the fifth time?

What is one reminder you could hand over to a system?

MISSION 6.1

The Morning Mission Board

20 Minutes | You Will Need: Paper, markers or photos

The Idea

A visual routine shows the steps of the morning in order, so no one has to repeat them. Your child can check off each step as they go, and you can point to the board instead of nagging.

Make the board together. Use drawings, photos of your child doing each step or simple words. Keep it to four to six steps. Letting your child choose the pictures builds ownership.

Put it where it will be seen, such as the bedroom door or the bathroom wall.

Steps

1. List the morning steps with your child, such as get dressed, eat, brush teeth, pack bag.
2. Draw or photograph each step on a card or paper.
3. Arrange them in order on a board or wall.
4. Add a checkbox or a movable marker for each step.
5. Try it tomorrow and adjust anything that did not work.

Say This

> *"What's the first step on your board?"*
>
> *"You did it without me saying anything. Nice work."*

Plan It

When Will We Try This?

What I Need To Get Ready:

MISSION 6.1 NOTES

The Morning Mission Board

Notice

- [ ] Which steps are quickest and which take longest.
- [ ] Whether pointing to the board replaces reminders.
- [ ] How your child feels about checking items off.
- [ ] The steps that need extra support.

Guardian Pause

When your child gets stuck, point to the board instead of speaking. Waiting even five seconds before stepping in gives your child a chance to take the next move on their own.

If It Isn't Working

If the board is ignored, shrink it to three steps or add a small reward at the end. Check that the order makes sense to your child, and let them rearrange it.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MISSION 6.2

The Launch Pad

15 Minutes | You Will Need: A hook, a basket, a shelf

The Idea

Items go missing when they have no home. A launch pad is a dedicated spot near the door where everything for tomorrow gets placed the night before: bag, shoes, jacket, library book, water bottle.

Setting it up together turns "Where are my shoes?" into "They're on the launch pad." It reduces the morning scramble and gives your child a sense of control.

Label the spots with pictures if needed and keep the pad clear of everything else.

Steps

1. Pick a spot near the front door.
2. Add hooks, a basket and a shelf at your child's height.
3. Label each place with a picture or word.
4. Practise the night-before routine together.
5. Do a quick "launch check" before leaving in the morning.

Say This

> *"Everything for tomorrow goes on the launch pad."*
> *"Run a launch check. Is anything missing?"*

Plan It

When Will We Try This?

What I Need To Get Ready:

MISSION 6.2 NOTES

The Launch Pad

Notice

- [ ] Items that tend to disappear.
- [ ] Whether your child uses the pad without reminders.
- [ ] How mornings feel with a launch pad in place.
- [ ] What would make it easier to use.

Guardian Pause

When something lands in the wrong place, resist the urge to sigh. Gently say, "Where does that live?" and let your child move it. Consistency beats perfection.

If It Isn't Working

If the pad becomes a dumping ground, do a weekly reset together. If your child still forgets, add a reminder picture to the door.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MISSION 6.3

One-Step Cards

15 Minutes | You Will Need: Index cards, markers

The Idea

"Clean your room" is not one task. It is ten. For a child who is easily overwhelmed, that one sentence can feel impossible. Breaking a big task into small steps on separate cards makes it manageable.

Write each step on a card, such as "Put books on the shelf" and "Put dirty clothes in the basket." Your child picks up one card at a time, does it and moves it to a finished pile. The cards show progress, which is motivating.

Start with a task that is not too heavy.

Steps

1. Choose a task such as tidying a bedroom or packing a bag.
2. Write each tiny step on its own card with your child.
3. Put the cards in a stack, face down or in order.
4. Your child takes one card, does the step and puts it in the done pile.
5. Celebrate when the stack is finished.

Say This

> *"Let's break it into tiny steps. What's the first one?"*
> *"Look at that done pile. You've finished six steps."*

Plan It

When Will We Try This?

What I Need To Get Ready:

MISSION 6.3 NOTES

One-Step Cards

Notice

- [ ] Which steps are hardest.
- [ ] How your child reacts to seeing the stack shrink.
- [ ] Whether they need a break halfway.
- [ ] How much less you needed to say.

Guardian Pause

Resist the urge to point out what is not done. Notice each completed card out loud. Calm encouragement keeps the effort alive.

If It Isn't Working

If it still feels overwhelming, start with only three cards. For older kids, use a list on paper they can cross out. Let them design the cards.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MISSION 6.4

Beat The Clock, Friendly

10 Minutes | You Will Need: A visual timer

The Idea

Time is invisible, which makes it hard to manage. A visual timer that shows time shrinking turns it into something you can see. It lets your child pace themselves, and it gives you a neutral way to measure instead of repeating "hurry up."

Use it as a friendly challenge, not a threat. The aim is to see how much can be done before the timer ends, with you cheering rather than pressuring.

Pair it with a short, specific task like putting away toys.

Steps

1. Choose a visual timer, sand timer or phone countdown.
2. Pick a short task and estimate the time it needs.
3. Set the timer and start together.
4. Cheer progress as the time shrinks.
5. When it rings, celebrate whatever got done.

Say This

> *"Let's see how much we can do before the timer ends."*
> *"You beat your own record. Nice."*

Plan It

When Will We Try This?

What I Need To Get Ready:

MISSION 6.4 NOTES

Beat The Clock, Friendly

Notice

- ☐ Whether the visual timer works better than spoken time warnings.
- ☐ How your child reacts when it runs out.
- ☐ Whether they begin to estimate time more accurately.
- ☐ The tasks that suit timing and those that do not.

Guardian Pause

Stay beside your child as a cheerleader and work on something of your own at the same time. When you are calm and busy, the task feels less like a standoff.

If It Isn't Working

If the timer causes stress, switch to a gentle melody that plays until a task is done, or time yourself instead. Keep the stakes low.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MISSION 6.5

The Evening Reset

10 Minutes | You Will Need: A short checklist

The Idea

A five-minute reset at the end of the day makes tomorrow easier. It might include a quick tidy of the main living space, checking the launch pad and looking at tomorrow's plan.

This mission ties the other systems together. Keep it short and predictable, and do it at the same time each evening. Over time it becomes part of the family rhythm, and your mornings should feel calmer.

Make it a team effort where everyone has a job.

Steps

1. Pick a regular time, such as just after dinner.
2. Agree on three to four resets: tidy the living room, check the launch pad, lay out clothes.
3. Put them on a short checklist.
4. Set a five-minute timer and do them together.
5. End by looking at tomorrow's plan.

Say This

> *"Time for our reset. What's first on the list?"*
>
> *"Thanks for doing that. Tomorrow will be easier."*

Plan It

When Will We Try This?

What I Need To Get Ready:

MISSION 6.5 NOTES

The Evening Reset

Notice

- [ ] Which resets your child does most easily.
- [ ] Mornings after a reset versus without.
- [ ] How you feel at the end of the day.
- [ ] What you might drop to keep it simple.

Guardian Pause

Let go of perfection. The living room does not need to look like a magazine. Five good-enough minutes are better than a long evening of nagging.

If It Isn't Working

If it drags on, cut the list in half. If evenings are too tired, move the reset earlier. Pick the shortest version you can keep up.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MODULE 6 DEBRIEF

Look Back

Which system worked best, and why do I think it helped?

What reminder did I manage to hand over to a system?

What did I notice about my own patience this week?

Mission Check-Off

Done	Mission	How It Went
☐	6.1 The Morning Mission Board	
☐	6.2 The Launch Pad	
☐	6.3 One-Step Cards	
☐	6.4 Beat The Clock, Friendly	
☐	6.5 The Evening Reset	

MODULE 6 DEBRIEF

Look Ahead

One thing to keep doing:

One thing to change:

A small win to celebrate:

How steady did my patience feel in this module? (1 = stretched, 5 = steady)

1 2 3 4 5

A Sentence I Want To Say To My Child This Week:

A Strength I Will Watch For This Week:

MODULE 7

Learning Style

From Restless Learner To Confident Learner

★ Meet The Power

School can be the hardest part of the day. Sitting still, copying from the board, finishing worksheets and waiting for turns all ask for the very skills that come least naturally to many kids with ADHD.

At home, that difficulty can arrive in the form of homework battles. Tears, bargaining and a pencil that has gone missing three times can turn a twenty-minute task into a two-hour standoff.

Yet the same children often learn brilliantly in other ways. They may remember everything about a topic they love. They may learn best by doing, moving, drawing, talking or teaching. Their curiosity may run far beyond the curriculum. A restless learner is often an active one.

This module focuses on finding how your child learns best and building homework and school routines around it. You will test different approaches, set up a simple homework launch and build a team with your child's teacher.

Nothing here replaces the support your child's school and professionals can offer. Think of these missions as practical home experiments that give you something helpful to share with them.

For you, patience means staying out of the power struggle. Your job is to set up the conditions and stay calm. Your child's job is to do the learning. When you hold both lightly, homework gets easier.

★ A restless learner is often an active learner. Find the doorway that fits. ★

★ Trait Map

What You See	What It Can Grow Into	Where It Trips You Up	Sidekick Tool
Fidgets during homework	Learns by doing	Takes forever to finish	Movement and hands-on options
Remembers topics they love	Strong memory when interested	Dull subjects slip away	Link lessons to favourite interests
Rushes and makes careless mistakes	Quick thinker	Lower marks than they know	Short sprints and a check step
Needs frequent breaks	Works in bursts with energy	Focus fades after ten minutes	Brain Break Menu

⓫ Patience Check-In

Describe the usual homework scene in your house. Where does your patience run out first?

Which part of homework could you hand back to your child, or simplify?

MISSION 7.1

Learning Style Test Drive

20 Minutes | You Will Need: A short list to learn

The Idea

Not every child learns well by reading or copying. This mission is a friendly experiment: try learning the same small list in three different ways and see which feels best.

Use something real, like five spelling words or five facts from school. Let your child try saying it out loud, moving while repeating it, and drawing it. Then ask which method felt easiest.

You are not looking for a label. You are collecting clues about what helps your child take information in.

Steps

1. Choose a short list of five items to learn.
2. Try method one: say and repeat each item out loud.
3. Try method two: move or act out each item.
4. Try method three: draw a quick picture for each item.
5. Test your child on the list and ask which way felt best.

Say This

> *"Let's try three ways to learn these and see which one works for you."*
> *"Which way made it easiest to remember?"*

Plan It

When Will We Try This?

What I Need To Get Ready:

MISSION 7.1 NOTES

Learning Style Test Drive

Notice

- [ ] Which method led to the best recall.
- [ ] Which method your child enjoyed most.
- [ ] Whether they asked to repeat any method.
- [ ] How you feel being the helper rather than the teacher.

Guardian Pause

If your child gets some items wrong, skip the correction speech. Say "Good try, let's look at that one together." Your calm tone keeps their confidence up.

If It Isn't Working

If all methods feel hard, try shorter lists or add a fourth method such as singing or tapping a rhythm. Different tasks may suit different methods, so test again another day.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MISSION 7.2

The Homework Launch

15 Minutes | You Will Need: Snack, water, a timer

The Idea

The first few minutes of homework are the hardest. A launch routine eases the start. It is a short, repeatable sequence that happens before any work: a snack, a drink, a quick movement and a clear plan.

Doing the same things in the same order every day makes it easier to begin without a fight. It also helps you avoid starting with "Have you done your homework?" which often triggers resistance.

Design the launch together and keep it brief.

Steps

1. Choose a regular homework time, with a short break after school first.
2. Agree on launch steps: snack, water, two-minute stretch, set up the space.
3. Write them on a card in order.
4. Look at the homework together and decide what to do first.
5. Start a timer and begin.

Say This

> *"Launch time. What's the first step on your card?"*
> *"Let's pick the first task together."*

Plan It

When Will We Try This?

What I Need To Get Ready:

MISSION 7.2 NOTES

The Homework Launch

Notice

- [ ] How long the launch takes.
- [ ] Whether starting feels easier.
- [ ] Which launch steps matter most.
- [ ] How you handle the urge to hover.

Guardian Pause

Once your child begins, step back. Sit nearby with your own task. If you feel the urge to correct, hold it for a moment. A calm presence can say more than a comment.

If It Isn't Working

If the launch drags out, trim it to two steps. If your child is exhausted after school, try a later time or a longer break first. Be flexible while keeping the order the same.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MISSION 7.3

Chunk And Choose

10 Minutes | You Will Need: Homework, a pencil, sticky notes

The Idea

A big pile of homework looks endless. Chunking splits it into small pieces, and choosing gives your child some control over the order. Control reduces resistance.

Break the work into chunks of five to ten minutes, write each on a sticky note and let your child arrange them. Which one first? Which one is the most fun? Which gets saved for last? They peel off each note as they finish.

The visible progress is motivating, and the choices build planning skills.

Steps

1. Look at the homework together.
2. Split it into chunks of about ten minutes.
3. Put each chunk on its own sticky note.
4. Let your child choose the order.
5. Remove each note as it is finished and take a short break between chunks.

Say This

> *"Let's break this into pieces. Which would you like to start with?"*
> *"One chunk down. Take a quick break."*

Plan It

When Will We Try This?

What I Need To Get Ready:

MISSION 7.3 NOTES

Chunk And Choose

Notice

- [ ] The order your child chooses.
- [ ] Whether choice reduces resistance.
- [ ] How they respond to peeling off the notes.
- [ ] Chunks that need to be smaller.

Guardian Pause

Accept an order that differs from yours. If they pick the hardest task first, great. If they pick the easiest, that works too. What matters is that they start.

If It Isn't Working

If your child cannot decide, offer two choices only. If they rush through to peel off notes, add a quick check step: "Show me one answer you're proud of."

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MISSION 7.4

Teacher Team-Up

20 Minutes | You Will Need: Paper or email

The Idea

Your child's teacher sees a side of your child that you do not, and you see a side the teacher does not. Sharing that knowledge helps everyone. A short, friendly note that starts with strengths builds a partnership.

Write the note together with your child if they are willing. Share what you have learned in this book, such as what motivates them and which supports have helped at home. Ask what the teacher sees, and how you can work together.

This note is not a request for a diagnosis or a medical opinion. It is a conversation between people who care about the same child.

Steps

1. List three strengths and interests you know about your child.
2. List two things that have helped at home.
3. Write a short note that shares both and asks what the teacher has noticed.
4. Ask whether you can meet or talk for ten minutes.
5. Follow up with thanks.

Say This

> *"I'd love to hear what you see in class, and share what's working at home."*
> *"Thank you for helping us support our child."*

MISSION 7.4 NOTES

Teacher Team-Up

Notice

- [ ] How the teacher responds.
- [ ] New ideas that come from the conversation.
- [ ] How your child feels about you and the teacher working together.
- [ ] What you can try at home as a result.

Guardian Pause

If the conversation touches on worries, breathe and listen first. You can take notes and reply later. You do not need to solve everything in the meeting.

If It Isn't Working

If you do not hear back, try again with a short message or ask the school office who is the best contact. If the relationship is strained, ask whether another member of staff could join the conversation.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MISSION 7.5

The Brain Break Menu

15 Minutes | You Will Need: Paper, markers

The Idea

Breaks work best when they are planned. A Brain Break Menu is a list of quick, two-minute activities your child can choose between homework chunks. Because they chose the options, it feels more like a treat than an interruption.

Make the menu together and decorate it. Include movement, calming and fun choices: jumping jacks, drawing a doodle, a drink and stretch, a quick song, a silly dance, a few slow breaths.

Set a timer so breaks stay short.

Steps

1. Brainstorm break ideas with your child.
2. Choose six that take two minutes or less and need no screen.
3. Write or draw them on a menu and put it where homework happens.
4. Use it between chunks, letting your child pick.
5. Set a timer for two minutes and return to work when it rings.

Say This

> *"Time for a brain break. What's on the menu?"*
>
> *"Two minutes. Then we're back for the next chunk."*

Plan It

When Will We Try This?

What I Need To Get Ready:

MISSION 7.5 NOTES

The Brain Break Menu

Notice

- [ ] Which breaks your child picks.
- [ ] Whether they return to work easily.
- [ ] Breaks that make things harder to restart.
- [ ] How your child feels about the menu.

Guardian Pause

Take a brain break yourself. A quick stretch or a sip of water between chunks resets your patience, too. You are modelling the habit.

If It Isn't Working

If breaks stretch out, shorten them or use a visual timer. If your child hates stopping, let them decide when to break within a set number of chunks.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MODULE 7 DEBRIEF

Look Back

Which learning method or routine worked best for my child?

What did I learn about how my child likes to learn?

What did I notice about my own patience this week?

Mission Check-Off

Done	Mission	How It Went
☐	7.1 Learning Style Test Drive	
☐	7.2 The Homework Launch	
☐	7.3 Chunk And Choose	
☐	7.4 Teacher Team-Up	
☐	7.5 The Brain Break Menu	

MODULE 7 DEBRIEF

Look Ahead

One thing to keep doing:

One thing to change:

A small win to celebrate:

How steady did my patience feel in this module? (1 = stretched, 5 = steady)

1 2 3 4 5

A Sentence I Want To Say To My Child This Week:

A Strength I Will Watch For This Week:

MODULE 8

Allies And Comebacks

From Social Struggles To Real Confidence

★ Meet The Power

Friendship is where many parents feel the sharpest worry. You may have watched your child get left out, say the wrong thing at the wrong time or melt down after losing a game. It hurts to watch, and it is hard to know how to help.

Kids with ADHD often have wonderful qualities that friends love: humour, energy, loyalty, imagination and generosity. They may also struggle with turn-taking, reading cues and handling disappointment. After a lot of corrections, some children begin to believe they are bad at people or bad at everything.

That belief is the real obstacle. Confidence is built from small experiences of success, from adults who notice effort, and from learning that mistakes are survivable. Every hero has setbacks. What defines them is the comeback.

This final module brings the book together. You will practise friendship skills through play, celebrate mistakes, build a record of wins and finish with a letter that tells your child who they are.

For you, patience here is about believing in the long game. Skills grow slowly. Your steady belief in your child is the thing they carry into every playground, classroom and workplace.

★ **Every hero has setbacks. What defines them is the comeback.** ★

★ Trait Map

What You See	What It Can Grow Into	Where It Trips You Up	Sidekick Tool
Loud, fun, generous with friends	Natural charisma and loyalty	Overwhelms or dominates play	Friendship Recipe and practice
Struggles with losing	Competitive spirit and drive	Tears or anger after games	Turn-Taking Practice
Hard on themselves after mistakes	High standards and care	Quick to give up or say "I'm dumb"	Oops Olympics
Hears more criticism than praise	Resilient with the right support	Low confidence	Brag Board and specific praise

⏸ Patience Check-In

When was the last time you worried about your child with other kids? What did you wish you could say to them?

What is one thing about your child you hope they hear from you more often?

MISSION 8.1

The Friendship Recipe

15 Minutes | You Will Need: Paper, pencils

The Idea

Friendship has ingredients, and kids can learn them like a recipe. In this mission you and your child write a simple Friendship Recipe: the things that make someone a good friend and how to do them.

Include small, specific actions such as saying hello, asking a question, sharing, waiting for a turn and saying sorry. Then act out a few scenes together, such as joining a game that is already going. Practice at home makes the real moment less stressful.

Keep it playful. Take turns playing the friend, and let your child direct the scenes.

Steps

1. Ask: "What makes someone a good friend?" and list the answers.
2. Pick the three most important ingredients.
3. Turn each into a simple action your child can do.
4. Act out one scene, such as asking to join a game.
5. Swap roles and try again.

Say This

> *"What do good friends do? Let's make a recipe."*
>
> *"Let's practise asking to join. I'll be the other kid."*

MISSION 8.1 NOTES

The Friendship Recipe

Notice

- [ ] Ingredients your child already knows.
- [ ] Moments of embarrassment and how they handled them.
- [ ] Which skills feel easy and which feel hard.
- [ ] Their sense of humour in the role-play.

Guardian Pause

If your child makes a social mistake during practice, hold back the correction. Say, "Let's try that again." Playful repetition teaches more than a lecture.

If It Isn't Working

If role-play feels awkward, use stuffed toys as the characters. If your child resists, talk about a favourite TV show's friendships instead.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MISSION 8.2

Turn-Taking Practice

15 Minutes | You Will Need: A simple board or card game

The Idea

Games are a gentle gym for social skills. Waiting, following rules, winning and losing all come up in a ten-minute game. Practising at home in a safe setting prepares your child for the playground.

Choose a quick game your child enjoys. Name the skills out loud while you play: "I'm waiting for my turn." Model losing well by saying "Good game" and meaning it. Praise effort and kindness, not just winning.

Short games work best. Play two or three rounds and end while it is still fun.

Steps

1. Pick a short game with clear turns.
2. Before you start, agree on one skill to practice, such as waiting or saying good game.
3. Play and notice the moments when it is hard.
4. When someone loses, say "Good game" and shake hands.
5. Talk afterward about what went well.

Say This

> *"It's your turn in a moment. I'm waiting patiently."*
>
> *"Good game. I enjoyed playing with you."*

Plan It

When Will We Try This?

What I Need To Get Ready:

MISSION 8.2 NOTES

Turn-Taking Practice

Notice

- [ ] How your child handles waiting.
- [ ] Their reaction to losing.
- [ ] Moments they showed kindness.
- [ ] How you handle losing yourself.

Guardian Pause

Lose on purpose once or twice and show how you handle it, calmly and with humour. Your reaction is the model they will copy.

If It Isn't Working

If losing leads to a meltdown, choose cooperative games where you work as a team. Stop the game early if emotions rise, and try again later.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MISSION 8.3

Oops Olympics

10 Minutes | You Will Need: Paper, a medal made of foil or card

The Idea

Mistakes are part of learning, but many kids with ADHD feel them sharply. They have heard "careless" and "silly" too often. The Oops Olympics flips the script and celebrates mistakes as proof of trying.

Each person names a recent mistake, says what they learned and receives a pretend medal. Share your own first. When children see adults laugh at their errors and learn from them, mistakes feel less shameful.

Keep the tone warm and lighthearted, never mocking.

Steps

1. Make simple medals from card and string or foil.
2. Take turns sharing a recent oops, big or small.
3. For each, ask: "What did you learn?"
4. Award a medal and a cheer.
5. Start a "lessons learned" list in this book.

Say This

> *"My oops today was burning the toast. I learned to set a timer."*
> *"Gold medal for trying! What did you learn?"*

Plan It

When Will We Try This?

What I Need To Get Ready:

MISSION 8.3 NOTES

Oops Olympics

Notice

- [ ] How your child reacts to sharing a mistake.
- [ ] What they say they learned.
- [ ] Whether they become more willing to try new things.
- [ ] Your own feelings about sharing mistakes.

Guardian Pause

Resist fixing or lecturing during the ceremony. The medal is the message. If you feel a lecture rising, take a breath and cheer instead.

If It Isn't Working

If your child won't share, start with your own oops until they feel safe. If they say "I don't make mistakes," smile and share another of yours.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MISSION 8.4

The Brag Board

15 Minutes | You Will Need: A board, paper, pens

The Idea

Many kids with ADHD hear far more correction than praise. The Brag Board redresses the balance with a visible record of what they have done well. Wins can be big or small: finishing a page of reading, being kind to a sibling, trying a new food, staying calm in a tough moment.

The praise that works best is specific. "Great job" slides past. "You waited your turn even though you wanted to go first" lands. Specific praise tells your child exactly what to repeat.

Add to the board every day, and read it aloud on hard days.

Steps

1. Choose a board, wall space or large sheet of paper.
2. Let your child decorate it and give it a name.
3. Each day, write one specific win on a sticky note or card.
4. Ask your child to add their own wins, too.
5. Read the board together once a week.

Say This

> *"I noticed you stayed calm when your sister took your toy. That took strength."*
> *"What's one thing you're proud of this week?"*

Plan It

When Will We Try This?

What I Need To Get Ready:

MISSION 8.4 NOTES

The Brag Board

Notice

- [ ] How your child responds to specific praise.
- [ ] Wins they notice themselves.
- [ ] Whether the board lifts their mood.
- [ ] How hard or easy it is for you to find wins on a rough day.

Guardian Pause

On a tough day, look hard for one true thing to praise. Finding it shifts your own mood, too. Strengths are always there, even when behaviour is not at its best.

If It Isn't Working

If your child dismisses praise, keep it short and factual, without gushing. If they cannot think of wins, offer a few choices and let them pick.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MISSION 8.5

The Hero Letter

20 Minutes | You Will Need: Paper, pen, a quiet moment

The Idea

This final mission is a gift. Write your child a letter that names who they are, what you see in them and what you hope for them. Read it together, or leave it where they can find it.

A letter can be kept and returned to on hard days. It is evidence from the person who knows them best that they are loved, capable and seen.

Take your time. Use real examples from the missions in this book. Be honest, specific and warm.

Steps

1. Find a quiet time to write alone.
2. Begin with: “Dear [name], here are the things I see in you.”
3. Include three strengths with a real example of each.
4. Add one moment from this book that made you proud.
5. End with a sentence of love and belief, and give it to your child.

Say This

> *“I wrote something for you. Would you like me to read it, or read it yourself?”*
> *“I wrote this because I see how special you are.”*

Plan It

When Will We Try This?

What I Need To Get Ready:

MISSION 8.5 NOTES

The Hero Letter

Notice

- [ ] How your child reacts as you read.
- [ ] What they ask about afterward.
- [ ] Where they keep the letter.
- [ ] How it feels to write it.

Guardian Pause

Write a short letter to yourself, too. Name three things you did well as a parent this month. You are the Hero Guardian, and you deserve to be seen as well.

If It Isn't Working

If writing is hard, record a voice message or draw a picture with captions. If your child is not ready to hear it, tuck the letter away for a day when they are.

How It Went

Date And Time:

How My Child Responded:

What Worked:

What I Would Change:

How Did It Go? (1 = Tough, 5 = Great)

1 2 3 4 5

How Steady Was My Patience? (1 = Stretched, 5 = Steady)

1 2 3 4 5

MODULE 8 DEBRIEF

Look Back

Which mission worked best, and what made it work?

What did I learn about my child's friendships and confidence?

What did I notice about my own patience this week?

Mission Check-Off

Done	Mission	How It Went
☐	8.1 The Friendship Recipe	
☐	8.2 Turn-Taking Practice	
☐	8.3 Oops Olympics	
☐	8.4 The Brag Board	
☐	8.5 The Hero Letter	

MODULE 8 DEBRIEF

Look Ahead

One thing to keep doing:

One thing to change:

A small win to celebrate:

How steady did my patience feel in this module? (1 = stretched, 5 = steady)

1 2 3 4 5

A Sentence I Want To Say To My Child This Week:

A Strength I Will Watch For This Week:

Patience Toolkit: The Five-Second Pause

This is the smallest patience tool in the book, and the one you will use most. The Five-Second Pause sits between what happens and what you do about it. Five seconds is not long, but it is often enough to change how a moment goes.

The pause has four short steps. Learn them now, while things are calm, so your body knows them when it counts.

1. **Stop.** Freeze your body and your mouth. Do not say the first thing.
2. **Breathe.** Take one slow breath in and a longer breath out. Let your shoulders drop.
3. **Name it.** Say silently: "I'm frustrated. My child is struggling. Both are true."
4. **Choose.** Ask: "What does my child need right now? What do I want to say?"

When you use the pause, you are not ignoring the problem or letting things slide. You are choosing a response instead of reacting. Some days you will manage it and some days you will not. Both are fine. Every attempt strengthens the habit.

Where I will practise the Five-Second Pause this week

- ☐ At the front door when we are leaving
- ☐ At the homework table
- ☐ At bedtime
- ☐ When I hear a sibling argument
- ☐ After a message from school
- ☐ Somewhere of my own:

Patience Toolkit: Guardian Reset Cards

Use these six cards when you feel your patience fraying. Read one aloud, copy it onto a sticky note or photograph this page and keep it on your phone.

Breathe Out

Make your out-breath longer than your in-breath. Do it three times.

Drop Your Shoulders

Notice where you are tense. Unclench your jaw and hands.

Lower Your Voice

Speak more softly and more slowly. A quiet voice is easier to hear.

Get Curious

Ask yourself: "What is my child trying to tell me with this behaviour?"

Name The Need

Is it hunger, tiredness, worry or a need for connection? Meet that first.

Step Away Safely

If you need space and your child is safe, say "I need a minute" and take it.

Which card do I need most? Why?

Which card will I try first, and when?

Patience Toolkit: My Trigger Tracker

Triggers are the moments that push you from calm to cross. Tracking them for a couple of weeks helps you plan for them. Write quickly. Facts are enough.

Date	Time	What Happened	What I Felt	What I Did	What I Could Try

Patterns I notice in my triggers:

Patience Toolkit: When I Lose It, My Repair Plan

Everyone loses their cool sometimes. What matters is the repair. Fill in this plan while you are calm so you know what to do next time.

After a hard moment, the first thing I will do for myself:

How long I will wait before reconnecting:

What I will say to my child:

How I will repair if my child is hurt or scared:

Who I can talk to if I feel guilty afterward:

One small step to prevent the same situation next time:

A reminder to my future self: a repair makes the relationship stronger, not weaker. Write your own version here.

Patience Toolkit: Be Kind To Yourself

Raising a child with extra needs is demanding work, often unseen. You are probably harder on yourself than anyone else is. This page is for the kind voice you would give a friend.

Try finishing these sentences honestly, then read them back slowly.

What I am doing well as a parent:

A hard thing I am carrying right now:

What I would tell a friend in my position:

One small thing I will do for myself this week:

A person or place that makes me feel supported:

A letter to myself on a hard day:

Patience Toolkit: Weekly Patience Tally

Once a week, rate your patience and add one line about what helped. The aim is not to climb a score. It is to see what you need.

Week	Patience (1-5)	What Helped	What Made It Harder
Week 1	1 2 3 4 5		
Week 2	1 2 3 4 5		
Week 3	1 2 3 4 5		
Week 4	1 2 3 4 5		
Week 5	1 2 3 4 5		
Week 6	1 2 3 4 5		
Week 7	1 2 3 4 5		
Week 8	1 2 3 4 5		

What I notice across the weeks:

Phrase Bank: Instead Of, Try

Words matter, but so does tone. These swaps are starting points. Use your own voice and adapt them to your child.

Instead Of	Try
"Why can't you ever listen?"	"I need your eyes for a moment. Then I'll say it once."
"Hurry up!"	"We leave in five minutes. What's left on your list?"
"Stop that right now."	"I need you to stop. Then we can try something else."
"You're being lazy."	"This looks hard. Where do you want to start?"
"I told you a hundred times."	"Let's make a reminder so we both remember."
"What is wrong with you?"	"Something is bothering you. Can you show me?"
"Calm down!"	"I'm here. Let's take a breath together."
"Why did you do that?"	"What were you hoping would happen?"
"You always do this."	"That was hard this time. What would make it easier?"
"Don't be so dramatic."	"That feels big to you. Tell me about it."
"Why can't you be more like your sister?"	"Everyone is good at different things. What are you good at today?"
"Because I said so."	"Here's the reason, and here's what happens next."

Swaps I want to try this week, in my own words:

Phrase Bank: Everyday Moments

Short, clear and calm works best for most kids. Say it once, make eye contact and give a moment to respond.

Moment	Try Saying
Starting something	"First this, then that."
Getting ready to leave	"Shoes, bag, water. Show me when you have all three."
Ending a favourite activity	"Ten minutes, then we save your place."
Trying something new	"You don't have to do it perfectly. You just have to try."
Before a tricky situation	"Here's what will happen. Here's what I'd like you to do."
When they are stuck	"Do you want help, or do you want me to stay close?"
After a mistake	"Everyone makes mistakes. What can we learn from this one?"
At bedtime	"Today was hard and also you did some good things. Tell me one."
When they are upset	"I can see this is big. I'm here."
When you need cooperation	"I need your help with one thing. Can you do it now or in two minutes?"
When you are running low	"I need a minute to calm down so I can listen properly."

The three phrases I will try first:

Phrase Bank: Praise That Sticks

Specific praise tells your child exactly what to do again. It sounds like noticing, not grading. Try describing the action, then naming the strength.

What You Saw	What You Might Say
They kept trying after a mistake	"You didn't give up. That's persistence."
They noticed someone was sad	"You saw how she felt and checked on her. That's kindness."
They waited their turn	"You waited even though it was hard. That took self-control."
They came up with an idea	"That was a clever idea. I never would have thought of it."
They stayed calm	"You took a breath and settled yourself. That is strength."
They helped without being asked	"You saw what needed doing and did it. That's responsibility."

Three specific things I can praise my child for today:

Phrase Bank: My Own Phrases

The phrases that work best are the ones that sound like you. Use this page to collect your own.

A phrase that calms my child:

A phrase that makes my child laugh:

A phrase that helps my child start:

A phrase that helps my child stop:

A phrase that tells my child I believe in them:

A phrase I want to stop using:

What I will say instead:

Notes on what I have learned about tone and timing:

30-Day Mission Tracker

Use this tracker to see your progress at a glance. Tick the box when you do a mission or a Guardian Pause. Rate your child's mood and your own patience from 1 to 5. A few words in the notes are plenty. You do not need to fill every box.

Day 1 Date: _____ ☐ Mission Done ☐ Guardian Pause

My Child's Mood (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) My Patience (1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

Note: _____

Day 2 Date: _____ ☐ Mission Done ☐ Guardian Pause

My Child's Mood (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) My Patience (1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

Note: _____

Day 3 Date: _____ ☐ Mission Done ☐ Guardian Pause

My Child's Mood (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) My Patience (1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

Note: _____

Day 4 Date: _____ ☐ Mission Done ☐ Guardian Pause

My Child's Mood (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) My Patience (1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

Note: _____

Day 5 Date: _____ ☐ Mission Done ☐ Guardian Pause

My Child's Mood (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) My Patience (1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

Note: _____

30-Day Mission Tracker, Continued

Day 6 Date: _____ ☐ Mission Done ☐ Guardian Pause

My Child's Mood 1 2 3 4 5 My Patience 1 2 3 4 5

Note: _____

Day 7 Date: _____ ☐ Mission Done ☐ Guardian Pause

My Child's Mood 1 2 3 4 5 My Patience 1 2 3 4 5

Note: _____

Day 8 Date: _____ ☐ Mission Done ☐ Guardian Pause

My Child's Mood 1 2 3 4 5 My Patience 1 2 3 4 5

Note: _____

Day 9 Date: _____ ☐ Mission Done ☐ Guardian Pause

My Child's Mood 1 2 3 4 5 My Patience 1 2 3 4 5

Note: _____

Day 10 Date: _____ ☐ Mission Done ☐ Guardian Pause

My Child's Mood 1 2 3 4 5 My Patience 1 2 3 4 5

Note: _____

30-Day Mission Tracker, Continued

Day 11 Date: _____ ☐ Mission Done ☐ Guardian Pause

My Child's Mood (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) My Patience (1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

Note: _____

Day 12 Date: _____ ☐ Mission Done ☐ Guardian Pause

My Child's Mood (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) My Patience (1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

Note: _____

Day 13 Date: _____ ☐ Mission Done ☐ Guardian Pause

My Child's Mood (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) My Patience (1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

Note: _____

Day 14 Date: _____ ☐ Mission Done ☐ Guardian Pause

My Child's Mood (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) My Patience (1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

Note: _____

Day 15 Date: _____ ☐ Mission Done ☐ Guardian Pause

My Child's Mood (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) My Patience (1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

Note: _____

30-Day Mission Tracker, Continued

Day 16 Date: _____ ☐ Mission Done ☐ Guardian Pause

My Child's Mood 1 2 3 4 5 My Patience 1 2 3 4 5

Note: _____

Day 17 Date: _____ ☐ Mission Done ☐ Guardian Pause

My Child's Mood 1 2 3 4 5 My Patience 1 2 3 4 5

Note: _____

Day 18 Date: _____ ☐ Mission Done ☐ Guardian Pause

My Child's Mood 1 2 3 4 5 My Patience 1 2 3 4 5

Note: _____

Day 19 Date: _____ ☐ Mission Done ☐ Guardian Pause

My Child's Mood 1 2 3 4 5 My Patience 1 2 3 4 5

Note: _____

Day 20 Date: _____ ☐ Mission Done ☐ Guardian Pause

My Child's Mood 1 2 3 4 5 My Patience 1 2 3 4 5

Note: _____

30-Day Mission Tracker, Continued

Day 21 Date: _____ ☐ Mission Done ☐ Guardian Pause

My Child's Mood (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) My Patience (1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

Note: _____

Day 22 Date: _____ ☐ Mission Done ☐ Guardian Pause

My Child's Mood (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) My Patience (1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

Note: _____

Day 23 Date: _____ ☐ Mission Done ☐ Guardian Pause

My Child's Mood (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) My Patience (1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

Note: _____

Day 24 Date: _____ ☐ Mission Done ☐ Guardian Pause

My Child's Mood (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) My Patience (1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

Note: _____

Day 25 Date: _____ ☐ Mission Done ☐ Guardian Pause

My Child's Mood (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) My Patience (1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

Note: _____

30-Day Mission Tracker, Continued

Day 26 Date: _____ ☐ Mission Done ☐ Guardian Pause

My Child's Mood 1 2 3 4 5 My Patience 1 2 3 4 5

Note: _____

Day 27 Date: _____ ☐ Mission Done ☐ Guardian Pause

My Child's Mood 1 2 3 4 5 My Patience 1 2 3 4 5

Note: _____

Day 28 Date: _____ ☐ Mission Done ☐ Guardian Pause

My Child's Mood 1 2 3 4 5 My Patience 1 2 3 4 5

Note: _____

Day 29 Date: _____ ☐ Mission Done ☐ Guardian Pause

My Child's Mood 1 2 3 4 5 My Patience 1 2 3 4 5

Note: _____

Day 30 Date: _____ ☐ Mission Done ☐ Guardian Pause

My Child's Mood 1 2 3 4 5 My Patience 1 2 3 4 5

Note: _____

Strengths Bank

This is where you collect evidence of your child's strengths, with real examples. On a hard day, read it. It is proof that the good stuff is real.

Strength	The Moment I Saw It	Date

Strengths Bank, Continued

Strength	The Moment I Saw It	Date

Wins Log

Big or small, write down the wins. Finishing a page, staying calm for a minute and saying sorry all count. Include your own.

Date	The Win	Why It Mattered

Wins Log, Continued

Date	The Win	Why It Mattered

Notes

Keep Going, Hero Guardian

You have come a long way. Maybe you did every mission. Maybe you did three and wrote in the margins. Either way, you showed up for your child, and that matters more than any page in this book.

Some of what you tried worked and some did not. That is how it goes. The goal was never a perfect child or a perfect parent. It was to see your child more clearly, to give their strengths room and to keep your own patience from running dry.

Keep the things that helped. Go back to the Phrase Bank. Reread your Wins Log on a rough day. Do the Five-Second Pause one more time before you speak. Small habits repeated are how families change.

Your child is not a problem to be solved. They are a person to be understood, and you are the one who is learning how.

Thank you for letting this book walk beside you for a while.

With respect and good wishes,

Cimple Books

My Hero Guardian pledge. Write one promise to yourself and one to your child.

Support And Next Steps

This workbook is a companion, not a substitute for professional guidance. You do not have to do this alone.

Talk with your child's professionals. If you have questions about diagnosis, treatment, medication or learning supports, speak with your child's doctor, psychologist or other qualified practitioner. Bring this workbook's notes and the Debrief pages to the conversation.

Work with the school. Share what you have learned about your child's strengths and what helps at home with their teacher, school counsellor or special educational needs contact. A short meeting can open up options.

Find your people. Many parents find relief in talking to others who understand. Look for local or online parent support groups, community centres and school parent networks.

Look after yourself. If you are feeling overwhelmed, low or unsafe, please reach out to your own doctor, a trusted person or local crisis services. Taking care of yourself is part of taking care of your child.

If anyone is in immediate danger, contact your local emergency services.

My child's professionals and their contact details:

School contacts:

People who support me:

Questions I want to ask next: